

Futile UTEP swamped as series swept

By BOB JACOBSON

TEMPE—You could label it a mercy killing.

Because Arizona State baseball coach Jim Brock was making sure he wouldn't be sued for a malpractice suit.

With his Sun Devils ahead, 20-0, in the bottom of the eighth inning here Saturday night, Brock—who had tried to get the game called after seven, but was turned down by Texas-El Paso coach Andy Cohen—resorted to pinchhitters. . .

. . . Who happen to pitch by trade. Jim Peterson singled, and with Don Hanna on deck, Tommy Van Der Meersche grounded out to end an onslaught that lasted three games, but must have seemed like years to the Miners.

The Devils won it, 20-0, completing a sweep that saw them down the hapless Texans, 11-2. Saturday afternoon before a Bicentennial crowd of 1,776. The night attendance was a healthy 2,659 at Packard Stadium to see a game in which there was absolutely no doubt about a winner.

The twin-killing, that's mercy, remember, upped the top-ranked Arizonans' season mark to 47-8 and 8-1 in Western Athletic Conference play. The Miners, who have been at least competitive sometimes in the past, fell to 7-18 and 1-8 respectively with what unquestionably is their worst club ever.

In the series, the Devils outscored UTEP, 52-2, and hit a resounding .422 (49-for-116). They slammed out seven homers upping their season total to 59, nine doubles and seven triples as all ASU regulars pounded the ball against no less than 10 Miner pitchers.

Hanna, Pat Gillie and Mitch Dean copped the hurling honors Saturday. Hanna hurled a strong eight-hitter in the afternoon win, striking out 10, and walking two in notching his 12th victory without a defeat.

Gillie and Dean combined for the evening shutout, Gillie Getting the win (his sixth) with six innings of five-hit ball, and Dean recording his seventh save with three frames of no-hit relief.

"I was very happy with the pitching," said Brock. "Hanna was super, he pitched really well. Gillie threw well, he was throwing hard and his curve ball was breaking quite a bit. As for our other pitchers, well, we might have to make them pinchhitters. . ."

"I'm a great hitter, aren't I?" laughed Peterson, now hitting 1,000 for the season. "We had been trying to talk him

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